

4.4. Creating and editing vector graphics

There are many tools available for editing vector graphics. We see two of these in this chapter.

- Inkscape
- Corel Draw

4.4.1. Inkscape

Inkscape is a free vector image editing tool available. It is very popular due to the range of features it provides for vector graphics.

Basic Features

There are certain basic features of any vector graphics editor such as positioning. Ways of positioning images include on-screen grid and guide lines where objects “snap” into alignment, dialogs for moving individual objects or for aligning multiple objects, and the create tiled clones dialog for placing multiple clones of an object. Additional features allow you to scale, skew or rotate an object. This section begins with a discussion of the coordinate system of Inkscape, followed by a discussion of the way Inkscape describes object transformations. Then, the commands and dialogs for transforming objects are discussed.

One key aspect to know is that transforming a regular shaped object or a group of objects by the methods described in this chapter does not usually change the underlying description of the objects. For example, suppose you have an ellipse that is 100 pixels wide but you need it to have a width of 50 pixels. There are two different ways to achieve the required width. The first is to scale the object by 50% in the horizontal (x) direction. The underlying definition of the ellipse width remains 100 pixels but when the ellipse is drawn a scale factor of 50% is applied in the horizontal direction. The second way to change the ellipse is to use the ellipse tool to resize the ellipse. In this case, the underlying description of the ellipse changes and no scale factor is applied.